CLASS 9 SST • HISTORY • CHAPTER 5 • RAPID REVISION

# State and Society up to 1000 CE

**One line:** Kin-based clans (janas) → territorial states (janapadas) → 16 mahājanapadas → empires (Maurya, Gupta, Chola) — while dharma & chakravarti samrāj united the subcontinent in values & governance.

⚡ 5-Minute Revision | 💡 Hinglish | 🗓️ Full Timeline | 🔥 Must-Remember Facts | 📝 Answer Guide

## 1 Chapter at a Glance

- **Big questions:** How did society & state organise before 1000 CE? How did states spread? How did dharma & chakravarti samrāj make the subcontinent ONE political entity? How did social/administrative/occupational groups form?
- From the **2nd millennium BCE** literary sources supplement archaeology — earliest = **Ṛig Veda** 📌
- **Society** = social relationships among people sharing territory, culture & belonging — regulated by **customs, not laws** | **State** = organised political system based on **rules & laws**, with defined rights/duties & law-enforcing institutions ⚠️ favourite difference question

## 2 Key Terms — one-line meanings

**Jana** — clan bound by kinship; basic unit of early Vedic society
**Janapada** — "where a jana first set its feet"; territorial identity (c. 1000–600 BCE)
**Rājya / Gaṇa-Saṁgha** — monarchy / republic (non-monarchical, e.g. Vajji)
**Samiti** — larger assembly; policy & political affairs
**Dharma** — NOT religion; duty, righteousness, moral conduct (root *dhri* = "that which upholds")
**Ṛita** — all-pervading cosmic order; harmony in nature & society (Ṛig Veda)
**Chakravarti samrāj** — ideal universal paramount ruler over the whole subcontinent
**Aśhvamedha** — horse sacrifice asserting sovereignty over the subcontinent
**Jāti** — birth-based groups; varṇas fixed at 4, jātis unlimited
**Āśhrama** — 4 stages of life: brahmacharya, gṛihastha, vānaprastha, saṁnyāsa
**Śhreṇī** — guild of one profession (traders/artisans/merchants)
**Agrahāram** — land grants to Brahmin settlements by **Chālukyas**
**Jambudvīpa, Bhāratavarṣha** — pan-Indian terms for one subcontinent-entity

**Kula** — family; smallest social unit
**Mahājanapada** — bigger political unit; 16 existed (600 BCE–300 CE)
**Sabhā** — smaller elite judicial assembly
**Vidhata** — popular gathering; warfare & political matters
**Dhamma** — Pali equivalent of dharma (Buddhism, Aśhoka's edicts)
**Samatva** — principle of sameness; all bodies = same matter, one consciousness
**Chakravarti-kśhetra** — area between Himavat (Himalayas) & the sea (Arthaśhāstra)
**Varṇa** — 4 social categories; earliest ref = Puruṣhasūkta, Book 10, Ṛig Veda
**Gotra** — patrilineal lineage from a common Vedic sage (ṛiṣhi); regulated marriage
**Puruṣhārtha** — 4 goals of life: dharma, artha, kāma, mokṣha
**Brahmadeya** — tax-free village land grants by **Pallavas**
**PGW / NBPW** — Painted Grey Ware / glossy "deluxe ware" of richer culture

## 3 🗓️ Timeline — all dates in one look

**c. 2000–500 BCE** — Vedic period; Ṛig Veda in Sapta-Sindhu (oral for centuries)
**c. 1000–600 BCE** — janapadas rise (kinship → territorial identity)
**321 BCE** — Chandragupta Maurya founds Mauryan Empire
**185 BCE** — Pushyamitra Shunga founds Shunga empire
**2nd c BCE–3rd c CE** — Satavāhana empire, Deccan (~500 yrs)
**c. 106–130 CE** — Gautamiputra Sātakarṇi (Satavāhana peak)
**c. 275–897 CE** — Pallavas (rise c. 300 CE)
**320–550 CE** — Gupta empire
**c. 480 CE** — Valabhi university
**543–753 CE** — Chālukyas of Badami
**629–645 CE** — Xuan Zang's (Chinese pilgrim) visit
**712 CE** — Arab conquest of Sindh
**c. 750 CE** — Pālas rise (east)
**783–820 CE** — Vikramashila university
**10th c CE** — Uttaramerur inscription (Parantaka I); Kudavolai
**11th c CE** — Rajendra I takes title *Gangaikonda*

**c. 1500–300 BCE** — Upaniṣhads composed
**600–300 BCE** — 16 mahājanapadas; Buddha & Mahāvīra
**272–232 BCE** — Aśhoka's reign; Dhamma
**300 BCE–300 CE** — Sangam age; Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas (Tamilakam)
**1st c CE** — Khāravela (Kalinga); Udayagiri & Khandagiri caves
**c. 150 CE** — Rudradaman I; Sanskrit inscription, repairs Sudarshana Lake
**300–650 CE** — Kāmarūpa (Assam region)
**427 CE** — Nalanda university
**c. 500 CE** — Āryabhaṭa (mathematician–astronomer)
**606 CE** — Harṣhavardhana annexes Kannauj (Maukhārīs 606–647)
**630–668 CE** — Narasimhavarman; Mahabalipuram rock-cut temples
**730–1036 CE** — Gurjara-Pratihāras; capital Kannauj; tri-partite struggle
**753–973 CE** — Rāṣhṭrakūṭas (Deccan)
**9th–11th c CE** — imperial Cholas; efficient admin & revenue
**985–1014 CE** — Rajaraja I; Brihadeeshwara Temple, Thanjavur

## 4 The Vedic Period — Beginnings

- Vedas = **earliest known corpus of Indian literature** (Harappan script still undeciphered) 🔥; existed **orally** for centuries before writing
- Ṛig Veda's date debated (5th millennium – 2nd millennium BCE); composed in NW **Sapta-Sindhu** — Indus + 5 tributaries + Sarasvatī; Ṛig Veda & Sindhu–Sarasvatī civilisation both knew **copper**
- Each Veda has 4 parts: **samhitā** (hymns) → **brāhmaṇa** (ritual prose) → **āraṇyaka** (forest philosophy) → **upaniṣhad** (Ātman & Brāhman) ⚠️ **Brāhman** (Universal Being) ≠ **Brāhmaṇas** (texts) ≠ **Brahmins** (varṇa)
- ~30 janas in Ṛig Veda; pañchajana = **Yadu, Turvaśha, Puru, Anu, Druhyu** 🔥; name **"Bharata"** first appears — from the Bharata jana ("India, that is Bharat"!)
- **Rājā** = primarily a clan chief (warfare leader, protector) — NOT an absolute territorial king

| Veda | Key points |
|---|---|
| **Ṛig Veda** | Earliest; ~1,028 hymns (sūktas) — world's oldest surviving poetry; praise of deities + creation, birth, death |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Yajur Veda** | Performative aspects of yajñas; prose explanations |
| **Sāma Veda** | Hymns for musical recitation → foundation of the **7 svaras** of Indian music 📌 |
| **Atharva Veda** | Hymns warding off evil, treating physical & mental ailments |

| Assembly | Nature | Function |
|---|---|---|
| **Sabhā** | Smaller, select elites | Primarily judicial |
| **Samiti** | Larger, broader population | Policy & political affairs |
| **Vidhata** | Popular gathering of the jana | Warfare & political discussions |

## 5 Janapadas → Mahājanapadas 📌 the big transition

| | |
|---|---|
| **WHAT** | Iron implements + fertile Gangetic plains → more settlements, paddy, PGW pottery; later glossy NBPW (middle Gangetic: Prayagraj → east Bihar) |
| **WHY** | Iron tools → agricultural surplus → control of land, produce & trade routes became valuable → complex administration needed |
| **NEXT** | c. 1000–600 BCE janapadas (territorial identity); 600 BCE–300 CE 16 mahājanapadas — 2 forms: rājyas (monarchies) & gaṇas/saṁghas (republics) |
| **RESULT** | **Magadha** (Bihar) most powerful — strategic location + fertile plains + strong rulers → expanded over neighbours |
| **WHY IT MATTERS** | Magadha → base of the **Mauryan Empire**; Vedic culture's centre shifted NW → Ganga plains |

- Janapada = "where a jana first set its feet" — identity changed from **kinship → territory** 🔥
- **The 16:** Kamboja, Gandhāra, Matsya, Kuru, Shūrasena, Pañchāla, Vatsa, Kosala, Kāśhī, Malla, **Vajji (republic)**, **Magadha (most powerful)**, Anga, Chedi, Avanti, Aśhmaka 📌
- In the Deccan, Mauryas succeeded by **Satavāhanas** (2nd c BCE–3rd c CE, ~500 years)

| Kingdom | Region | Emblem | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cholas** | Lower Kaveri valley | 🐯 Tiger | All three = "**Vendar of Tamilakam**" (crowned kings) in fertile rice regions; mentioned in Aśhokan inscriptions + Sangam literature. **Nedunjeral Adan** (Chera) won title *adhirāja*, conquered up to the Himalayas. ⚠️ Do NOT confuse with the later imperial Cholas (9th–11th c CE)! |
| **Pandyas** | Tamraparni & Vaigai valleys | 🐟 Fish | |
| **Cheras** | Kerala (Keralaputras) | 🏹 Bow | |
| **Satiyaputras** | Northern Tamil Nadu | none | |

## 6 Duties & Ideals of the King

- From 6th c BCE rulers used titles: **rājā, mahārāja, samrāj** (regional traditions)
- **Kauṭilya's Arthaśhāstra:** "Only if a king is himself energetically active, do his officers follow him energetically" 📌 (quote)
- **Yajur Veda coronation oath:** judge strong & weak impartially, protect from calamities, do good to the people; **Śhānti Parva** (Mahābhārata) = guidance on ethical rule
- Duties: protect subjects & internal order; justice (abduction, robbery, theft, adultery); severe punishment — cow-killing, treachery, intoxicating liquor
- Kingship generally **hereditary BUT** refs to elected/expelled kings → royal authority NOT always absolute ⭐
- **Pan-Indian awareness 🔥:** Jambudvīpa, Bhāratavarṣha, aśhvamedha & Rājasūya yajñas, Prithivi, chakravarti-kśhetra; Aśhoka's edict — his *parākrama* changed spiritual life of Jambudvīpa; Arthaśhāstra: Prithivi = "area between Himavat and the sea"; Rajendra I's title *Gangaikonda* (Ganga conquest)

## 7 How Were Empires Administered?

| 🔥 Kauṭilya's Saptāṁga — 7 limbs of state | |
|---|---|
| **1 King** (swāmi) | sovereign head |
| **2 Ministers** (mantrī/amātya) | council of ministers |
| **3 Territory** (janapada) | land + population |
| **4 Forts** (durga) | fortified towns |
| **5 Treasury** (kośha) | kingdom's wealth |
| **6 Army** (daṇḍa) | defence, law & order |
| **7 Allies** (mitra) | friendly states |

State = organic whole of 7; "one wheel does not move the carriage." **Mantri-pariṣhad:** treasurer, chief tax collector, legal advisor, commander — an Aśhokan inscription shows it decided independently in the emperor's absence 📌

| Level | North | South |
|---|---|---|
| Provinces | bhukti | maṇḍala(m) |
| Divisions | viṣhaya / bhoga | koṭṭam / valanāḍu |
| Districts | adhiṣhṭhāna / paṭṭana | nāḍu |
| Village groups | vithi (→ tahsīl) | paṭṭalā / kūṛram |

**Village = smallest unit** everywhere; Satavāhanas: āhāras + amātyas, grāmika headman; pradeśhikas = district governors; c. 300–800 CE = decentralisation for convenience

| Empire | Period | Key features 📌 |
|---|---|---|
| **Guptas** | 320–550 CE | mantri = head of civil admin; **NEW post — sāndhivigrahika** (minister of peace & war); kumārāmātyas = local admins; **Damodarpur plates** (Kumāragupta I): district office of 5 — officer, banker, caravan trader, artisan, revenue chief |
| **Pallavas** | c. 275–897 CE | Central monarchy + decentralised local govt; **Brahmadeya** tax-free grants; village assemblies with **variyams** (irrigation, gardens, temples) |
| **Chālukyas** | 543–753 CE | **Agrahārams** to Brahmin settlements; Aihole & Badami → centres of learning |
| **Gurjara-Pratihāras** | 730–1036 CE | Capital **Kannauj** (coveted); **tri-partite struggle** (Pratihāras–Pālas–Rāṣhṭrakūṭas); self-reliant villages |
| **Imperial Cholas** | 9th–11th c CE | maṇḍalam → valanāḍu → nāḍu → **Ur**; assemblies settled disputes, collected revenue, managed land/irrigation/roads/records — independent & self-reliant |

**🔥 UTTARAMERUR INSCRIPTION (case study)**

Parantaka I, 10th c CE, Vaikuṇṭha Perumal Temple (Kanchipuram dist., TN).
**Kudavolai** ("ballot pot"): names on palm leaves → pot → a young child drew leaves publicly → village assembly + committees (variyams: tank, justice, tax).
Candidates needed "honest earnings" + purity of mind — ethics in governance 📌

**🔥 JUNAGADH ROCK INSCRIPTION (case study)**

One rock (Girnar, Gujarat) — 3 rulers, ~700 years: **Aśhoka** (Prakrit, Dhamma) + **Rudradaman I** (Sanskrit; repaired Sudarshana Lake) + **Skandagupta** (restored the lake).
Significance: one site preserves Maurya + Śhaka + Gupta records — admin, public works, political history 📌

## 8 Ethics — Foundation of Law & Life

- Earliest texts discussed reality, right conduct, origin of universe; **Bhagavad Gītā**: knowledge, faith, action, virtue, ethical life
- **Samatva:** all bodies = same matter; all consciousness = one supreme consciousness; Vedas call it **satya** (true) & **ṛita** (right) — "the invisible origin of all things"; epics critique discrimination — good ruler "works for the welfare of all beings"
- **Ṛita** (Ṛig Veda) = all-pervading cosmic order — harmony & balance in nature & society ⭐
- **Dharma ≠ religion** 🔥 — duty, obligation, righteousness, moral conduct; from root *dhri* (also root of *dharati*, the earth); Bhishma: "that which upholds beings" (iron sinks, wood floats); **dhamma** = Pali form
- Politics–ethics link: Aśhoka's dhamma (non-violence, compassion); Uttaramerur's honesty; Kāmandaka's *Nītisāra* + Bāṇabhaṭṭa's *Kādambarī* (one of the world's first novels) 📌

## 9 Social Structure — Varṇa, Jāti & Family

| Varṇa | Expected roles |
|---|---|
| **Brāhmaṇas** | Study & teach Vedas; officiate yajñas; give & receive dāna |
| **Rajanya (Kṣhatriyas)** | Warfare, protection, justice; + scriptures, yajñas, social order |
| **Vaiśhyas** | Economy — agriculture, pastoralism, trade; + rituals, charity |
| **Śhūdras** | Assist other varṇas; in practice also farming, herding, trade, crafts |

- Earliest reference = **Puruṣhasūkta, Book 10, Ṛig Veda** 🔥; early Vedic identity NOT birth-fixed — shaped by ethnicity, region, gotra, language & **occupation** (flexible, mobile)
- Evidence: **Ṛig Veda 9.112.3** — "I am a poet, my father a physician, my mother a grinder of corn" 📌; Buddhist *Sutta Nipāta*: "No brāhmaṇa by birth... only by deeds"
- Varṇa = system of values: knowledge (highest) → political power → wealth
- **Jāti emerged** ⚠️ by (1) intermarriage among varṇas, (2) migrating communities turning endogamous, (3) territorial differences — varṇas fixed at 4, jātis unlimited
- **Mobility** ⭐**:** rulers from diverse backgrounds (Nandas, Mauryas, Shungas, Satavāhanas, Vākāṭakas, Guptas, Puṣhyabhūtis); **Mandsaur inscription 473 CE** — silk-weavers' guild migrated Lata (Gujarat) → Dashapura (MP), took up archery & astrology; **Karitalai plates** (Jayanātha, late 5th c) — brāhmaṇas as land managers; **Tolkappiyam** (Sangam): Arasar (kings), Vanigar (traders), Vellāḷar (farmers), Antanar (brāhmaṇas) — occupation-based, fluid 📌; Pattinappalai = trade-oriented society organised by occupation, not rigid varṇa
- **Family structure:** kula (family) → grāma (village) → viśha (viśhapati) → jana (rājā protector); **gotra** = patrilineal lineage from a sage — regulated marriage (patrilineal = through male line; endogamy = marrying within group)
- **ṣhoḍaśha-saṁskāras** = 16 rites of passage (birth → initiation → studies → marriage → death rites...); **4 āśhramas:** brahmacharya → gṛihastha → vānaprastha → saṁnyāsa; **4 puruṣhārthas** 🔥**:** dharma, artha, kāma, mokṣha (artha desirable only when guided by dharma)

## 10 Role of Women

- Vedic women: **high, respectful position** 🔥 — scholarly learning, rituals with men, chariot races, attended sabhā
- Women sages of Ṛig Veda (hymns attributed): **Apālā, Viśhvavārā, Ghoṣhā, Lopāmudrā**; goddesses Uṣhas (dawn), Aditi (mother of gods)
- **Manu-Smṛiti 3.56:** "Where women are honoured, there the gods rejoice; where not honoured, all sacred rites prove fruitless" 📌 (quote)
- Position later fluctuated/declined — but women kept contributing to household, agriculture, crafts, religion; post-Maurya **votive inscriptions** list women as donors
- **Prabhāvatī Gupta** (daughter of Chandragupta II) ruled as **regent** of Vākāṭaka kingdom, issued land grants in her own name ⭐
- Sangam: agrarian tasks, spinning, fishing, salt, garlands; poetesses **Avvaiyar** & Vennikuyattiyar (potter); Chola: **Sembiyan Mahādevī** — temple building

## 11 Religious Life & Emergence of Bhakti

- Vedic pantheon: **no rigid hierarchy** — different deities supreme in different hymns, each linked to nature; worship via prayers & yajñas; continuity today = **Chhath & Makar Sankranti** (nature = sacred, not merely a resource)
- Mid-1st millennium BCE **renunciants** 📌: parivrājaka (wanderer), bhikṣhu (alms), śhramaṇa (striver) — Buddha & Mahāvīra = influential thinkers; roots already in vānaprastha/saṁnyāsa
- Tradition evolved to Viṣhṇu, Śhiva, Śhakti → **Bhakti = direct connection with god, no elaborate rituals, open to ALL classes & genders** 🔥
- **Āḻvārs** (12, Viṣhṇu) + **Nāyanmārs** (63, Śhiva) — Tamil, 6th century → huge body of Tamil Bhakti literature

## 12 The Quest for Knowledge — Education

- Education = integral, holistic part of life — truth, patience, humility, purity (sattvaśhuddhi), unity of life & nature; **gurukula**: sacred guru-śhiṣhya paramparā, "from darkness of ignorance to light of knowledge"
- Subjects: Vedas + grammar, logic, philosophy, ethics, maths, science, medicine, astronomy + arts (music, dance, painting), archery, yoga — preparation for life, not just career
- Centres ⭐: **Takshashila** (urban campus: housing, drainage, waste mgmt), **Nalanda (427 CE)**, **Vikramashila (783–820)**, **Valabhi (c. 480)**, Odantapuri, Mithila, Kanchipuram, Pushpagiri, Somapura, Uddandapura, Sharada Peeth — students from India & abroad

## 13 Literary Heritage — quick table

**Grammar** — Pāṇini's Aṣhṭādhyāyī; Piṅgala's Chhandaśhāstra; Patañjali's Mahābhāṣhya

**Medicine** — Charakasaṁhitā & Suśhrutasaṁhitā

**Tamil** — Tiruvalluvar's Tirukkural; epics Silappadikāram & Maṇimēkalai; Sangam themes: akam (love) & puram (war/public life)

**Law & ethics** — Manu-Smṛiti; Yājñavalkya, Nārada, Viṣhṇu Smṛitis

**Kāvya (poetry)** — Kālidāsa's Raghuvaṁśha & Kumārasambhava

**Lexicon** — Amarakoṣha (chapter on forests, crops, plants, manure)

## 14 Economy — Agriculture, Irrigation, Trade & Guilds

- **Agriculture:** Mauryan state regulated — individual holdings + common pastures + groves; forest clearing encouraged (some forests protected); **land tax = 1/6 of produce** 🔥; land classified for revenue (Kauṭilya); crops: rice varieties, pulses, wheat, linseed, mustard, saffron, sugarcane; **Milindapañho** (Nāgasena) = 8 stages of farming; Deccan black soil → cotton; Chera: jackfruit, pepper, turmeric
- **Irrigation:** reservoirs, canals, dams in inscriptions; **Sudarshana Lake** (Girnar, Gujarat): dam by **Puṣhyagupta** (Chandragupta Maurya's governor) → repaired by **Rudradaman I** → restored by **Skandagupta** 📌; **Grand Anicut (Kallanai)** by Karikala Chola — **still in use today**
- **Trade 🔥:** by 6th c BCE two land routes — **Uttarāpatha (north) & Dakṣiṇāpatha (south)**; Arthaśhāstra: Magadha traded textiles, gems, coral, pearls, metals; **salt strictly state-regulated**; route safety + anti-adulteration; ports: **Muziris, Kāveripaṭṭinam (Poompuhar), Arikamedu, Masulipatnam**; Rome trade (sea + Central Asia overland); Silappadikāram: 2 Tamil routes (Kanchipuram → Poompuhar / → Kanyakumari)
- **Guilds (śhreṇīs) 🔥:** rose after mahājanapadas (6th c BCE) with **silver punch-marked coins** (earliest metallic); **Jātaka: 18 guild types** 📌; functions: quality control, price fixing, guild courts, **acted as banks/financiers/trustees**; **Nashik cave inscription** (2nd c CE, Śhaka king Nahapāna & Uṣhavadata): **3000 kāhāpaṇas** deposited with weavers' guilds at Govardhana at fixed interest → maintained Buddhist monasteries 📌 (source-based Q!); **Sanchi** southern gateway — ivory workers' guild of Vidiśhā (art + patronage); textiles: Mathura, Vārāṇasī, Kāmarūpa

## 15 Important People — who → did → why

**Chandragupta Maurya** — founded Mauryan Empire (321 BCE) on Magadha's base; his governor built Sudarshana dam

**Kauṭilya** — Arthaśhāstra author; Saptāṁga, Prithivi definition

**Khāravela** — Kalinga (1st c CE); Udayagiri & Khandagiri caves

**Rudradaman I** — Western Satrap (c. 150 CE); Sanskrit Junagadh inscription, lake repair

**Skandagupta / Kumāragupta I** — Guptas; lake restoration / Damodarpur plates; Faxian visited c. 400 CE

**Harṣhavardhana** — Puṣhyabhūti (606 CE, Kannauj); Xuan Zang's era

**Parantaka I** — Uttaramerur inscriptions (Kudavolai)

**Buddha & Mahāvīra** — renunciant thinkers (600–300 BCE)

**Kālidāsa / Tiruvalluvar / Bāṇabhaṭṭa** — Raghuvaṁśha / Tirukkural / Kādambarī (first novels)

**Aśhoka** — Mauryan (272–232 BCE); Dhamma, moral governance; Jambudvīpa authority

**Pushyamitra Shunga** — Shunga empire (185 BCE)

**Gautamiputra Sātakarṇi** — Satavāhana peak (c. 106–130 CE)

**Nedunjeral Adan** — Chera; adhirāja; conquests to Himalayas

**Prabhāvatī Gupta** — Vākāṭaka regent; land grants in own name

**Karikala Chola** — Grand Anicut, still in use

**Rajaraja I & Rajendra I** — Brihadeeshwara Temple; Gangaikonda title

**Nahapāna & Uṣhavadata** — Nashik guild-banking inscription

**Avvaiyar / Sembiyan Mahādevī / Nāgasena / Jayanātha** — poetess / temples / Milindapañho / Karitalai plates

## 16 📊 Quick Comparisons — confusable pairs

**Jana vs Janapada** — kinship-based clan vs territory-based state

**Janapada vs Mahājanapada** — smaller unit vs bigger (16, from 6th c BCE)

**Varṇa vs Jāti** — 4 fixed categories vs unlimited birth-based groups

**Brahmadeya vs Agrahāram** — Pallava grants vs Chālukya grants

**Early Tamil kingdoms vs Imperial Cholas** — 300 BCE–300 CE vs 9th–11th c CE

**Āśhrama (stage) vs Āśhrama (Saptāṁga)** — 4 life-stages vs hermitage

**Rājya vs Gaṇa-Saṁgha** — monarchy vs republic (e.g. Vajji)

**Dharma vs Dhamma vs Ṛita** — duty (Sanskrit) vs Pali form vs cosmic order

**Brāhman vs Brāhmaṇas vs Brahmins** — concept vs texts vs varṇa

**PGW vs NBPW** — Painted Grey Ware vs glossy "deluxe ware"

**Sabhā vs Samiti** — small judicial body vs larger policy assembly

**Uttarāpatha vs Dakṣiṇāpatha** — northern vs southern land route

## 17 💡 Hinglish Me Samjho — difficult concepts, ek line mein

**Society vs State:** society = log + customs (riwaaj); state = power + laws (likha-hua system).
**Jana → Janapada → Mahājanapada:** pehle identity khoon se ("Sharma family") → phir zameen se ("Delhi ke") → phir bade states ("India ke"). Vajji jaise = republic, ek raja nahi.
**Chakravarti samrāj:** Himalayas se samundar tak poore subcontinent ka "universal ruler" ideal — aśhvamedha ya north-south conquest se message: "hum poore Bhāratavarṣha ke hain."
**Dharma vs religion:** dharma = duty + righteousness (student ka padhna, raja ki raksha) — "jo sabko sambhale wahi dharma" (Bhishma). Pali version = dhamma.
**Varṇa vs Jāti:** varṇa = 4 broad branches; jāti = unlimited sub-groups (lohar, sunar...) — time ke saath badhti gayi.
**Village assemblies:** Chola gaon khud tax, irrigation, roads, justice sambhaalte — jaise aaj Panchayati Raj. Yahi decentralisation hai.
**Kudavolai:** 1000 saal pehle lottery-style voting — palm-leaf naam, matke mein, bachha public mein nikaalta tha. Ballot box ka purana version!
**Guild = bank:** śhreṇī mein deposit + fixed interest (Nashik) — quality control + price fixing + court + banking, sab ek institution mein.
**Bhakti:** seedha dil se connection — na priests, na bade rituals; class/gender koi barrier nahi.

## 18 🔥 MUST REMEMBER — if nothing else, this!

- **Evolution chain:** jana → janapada → mahājanapada → empire (kinship → territory → big states → empires)
- **321 BCE** Chandragupta Maurya; **272–232 BCE** Aśhoka & Dhamma; **320–550 CE** Guptas; **9th–11th c** imperial Cholas
- **16 mahājanapadas**; Magadha most powerful → base of Mauryan Empire
- Assemblies: **sabhā (judicial) / samiti (policy) / vidhata (popular)**; **Saptāṁga** = king + ministers + territory + forts + treasury + army + allies
- **Dharma ≠ religion**; Prithivi = "Himavat to the sea" = chakravarti-kśhetra; varṇa's earliest ref = **Puruṣhasūkta (Book 10, Ṛig Veda)**
- **Land tax 1/6**; routes **Uttarāpatha & Dakṣiṇāpatha** (6th c BCE); **guilds = 18 types (Jātaka)**, worked as banks (Nashik)
- Case studies: **Uttaramerur** (Kudavolai ballot), **Junagadh rock** (Aśhoka + Rudradaman I + Skandagupta), **Mandsaur** (silk weavers), **Sudarshana Lake** (3 rulers chain)

- Tamilakam: **Chola–tiger, Chera–bow, Pandya–fish**; Sangam 300 BCE–300 CE; **Āḻvārs (12, Viṣhṇu) & Nāyanmārs (63, Śhiva)** — 6th c

## 19 🧠 Memory Tricks

🧠 **Pañchajana "YTPAD":** Yadu, Turvaśha, Puru, Anu, Druhyu

🧠 **Saptāṁga:** "Raja-Mantri-Desh-Durg-Khazana-Fauj-Mitra"

🧠 **Āśhramas "B-G-V-S":** brahmacharya → gṛihastha → vānaprastha → saṁnyāsa

🧠 **Women sages "AVGL":** Apālā, Viśhvavārā, Ghoṣhā, Lopāmudrā

🧠 **Sangam "AVVA":** Arasar, Vanigar, Vellāḷar, Antanar

🧠 **Assemblies "S-S-V":** Sabhā (small, judicial) → Samiti (big, policy) → Vidhata (all villagers)

🧠 **Puruṣhārthas "DAKM":** Dharma, Artha, Kāma, Mokṣha

🧠 **Emblems:** "Chola Tiger, Chera Bow, Pandya Fish"

🧠 **Tri-partite "3 powers, 1 Kannauj":** Pratihāra, Pāla, Rāṣhṭrakūṭa

🧠 **Junagadh "A-R-S" (~700 yrs):** Aśhoka → Rudradaman → Skandagupta

## 20 ⚡ Last 5-Minute Revision — read before entering the exam hall

🗓️ **DATES**

2000–500 BCE Vedic; 1000–600 janapadas; 600–300 **16 mahājanapadas** + Buddha/Mahāvīra
**321** Maurya; **272–232** Aśhoka; **185** Shunga; 300 BCE–300 CE Sangam
2nd c BCE–3rd c CE Satavāhanas; c. 150 Rudradaman I; **320–550** Guptas; 427 Nalanda
543–753 Chālukyas; 712 Arab Sindh; **9th–11th c** Cholas; 10th c Uttaramerur; 985–1014 Rajaraja I

👤 **NAMES**

Kauṭilya (Arthaśhāstra) • Aśhoka (Dhamma) • Rudradaman I & Skandagupta (lake)
Nedunjeral Adan (adhirāja) • Rajendra I (Gangaikonda) • Prabhāvatī Gupta (regent)
Avvaiyar • Sembiyan Mahādevī • Kālidāsa • Tiruvalluvar • Bāṇabhaṭṭa • Āryabhaṭa
Nahapāna & Uṣhavadata (Nashik guild inscription)

📜 **DEFINITIONS**

Society = customs; State = laws | Janapada = "where jana set its feet"
Dharma = duty (NOT religion); Ṛita = cosmic order; Gotra = sage lineage; śhreṇī = guild

🔑 **CAUSES → EFFECTS**

Iron + Ganga plains → surplus → land/trade control → complex admin → **states**
Magadha's rise → **Mauryan Empire** | Agriculture = revenue → state built irrigation
States → infrastructure & safety → trade → **guilds as banks**

🧠 **CONCEPTS**

Assemblies limited rājā's power | Saptāṁga; provinces → districts → villages
Pan-Indian: Jambudvīpa, chakravarti-kśhetra, aśhvamedha | Bhakti = direct devotion, open to all

⚡ **10 RAPID-FIRE**

Ṛig Veda 1,028 hymns • Sāma Veda → 7 svaras • pañchajana = YTPAD • 'Bharata' from Bharata jana
Ports: Muziris, Arikamedu, Poompuhar • 18 guilds (Jātaka) • punch-marked coins earliest
Chola units: maṇḍalam → valanāḍu → nāḍu → Ur • Gupta NEW post: sāndhivigrahika
Land tax 1/6 • Grand Anicut still in use • Milindapañho: 8 farming stages • Amarakoṣha = lexicon

## 21 📝 How to Use These Points in an Answer

- **Formula:** Introduction (1–2 lines — define/context) → Body (3–5 numbered points, each with a keyword + example/proof) → Conclusion (1 line — overall judgement). Underline key terms & dates.
- **Q: "Explain the administrative system of early Indian states" (5m):** Intro = janas → territorial states → empires, multi-layered admin. Body = ① Saptāṁga (7 limbs; "one wheel..." quote) ② mantri-pariṣhad (treasurer, tax collector, legal advisor, commander) ③ layers: provinces → divisions → districts → villages ④ Damodarpur plates (5 district members) ⑤ Uttaramerur (self-reliant assemblies, Kudavolai). Conclusion = central authority + decentralised self-reliant local institutions.
- **Q: "How did dharma & chakravarti samrāj promote unity?" (5m):** Intro = dharma binds rulers & subjects; chakravarti = one paramount ruler. Body = ① dharma, ṛita, samatva — shared values ② Jambudvīpa, Bhāratavarṣha, chakravarti-kśhetra ③ aśhvamedha & Rājasūya ④ Aśhoka's Dhamma; Nedunjeral Adan; Rajendra I's Gangaikonda ⑤ Uttaramerur's "honest earnings". Conclusion = shared values made the subcontinent one political entity despite many kingdoms.
- **Q (source-based): "Nashik cave inscription — economic role of guilds?" (3m):** ① 3000 kāhāpaṇas invested with weavers' guilds (Govardhana) at fixed interest ② interest maintained Buddhist monasteries & caves ③ guilds = trusted banking/credit institutions. Conclusion = guilds = banks + financiers of early India.
- **Q: "Varṇa & women in early Indian society" (5m):** ① Puruṣhasūkta (Book 10) + originally occupation-based & flexible (Ṛig Veda 9.112.3) ② Sutta Nipāta "by deeds"; jāti via intermarriage + endogamy ③ mobility: diverse rulers; Mandsaur silk weavers ④ women: Vedic education + sages (Apālā, Lopāmudrā); Prabhāvatī Gupta; Avvaiyar; Sembiyan Mahādevī ⑤ later decline. Conclusion = society more fluid than assumed — hierarchy AND mobility.